

Sandgrouse

Order Pteroclidiformes

Crowned sandgrouse

Pterocles coronatus

- ↔ 11–12 in (27–30 cm)
- 📍 N. Africa, W. to S. Asia
- ⊗ Common

This partridge-like desert bird can survive air temperatures of up to 122°F (50°C), thanks to its ability to conserve moisture and drink the salty water formed by evaporation under the desert sun. It feeds on seeds and the tips of plants that sprout after rare rainstorms.

Parrots

Order Psittaciformes

Galah

Eolophus roseicapilla

- ↔ 14 in (35 cm)
- 📍 Australia (including Tasmania)
- ⊗ Common

Elegant in pale gray with deep rose-pink underparts and a paler pink crown, this cockatoo is one of the most abundant and widespread Australian parrots. The sexes are similar, differing only in eye color: brown in the male and red in the female. The galah lives in large,

screaming flocks in open or thinly wooded terrain, feeding on seeds, buds, and insects, as well as juicy roots, which it digs up with its bill. The expansion of arable farming in Australia has dramatically increased its food supply, and the galah is commonly seen as an agricultural pest.



Rainbow lorikeet

Trichoglossus haematodus

- ↔ 12 in (30 cm)
- 📍 New Guinea, SE. Asia, SW. Pacific, Australia (including Tasmania)
- ⊗ Common

This long-tailed parrot is named for its multicolored plumage, with patches of blue, green, yellow, orange, and bright red. But it is very variable, with 22 distinct races across its large range. Like most lorikeets, it has a brush-tipped tongue for gathering nectar and pollen from flowers, and typically feeds in noisy flocks on treetops.

Gray parrot

Psittacus erithacus

- ↔ 13 in (33 cm)
- 📍 W. to C. Africa
- ⊗ Vulnerable

Renowned for its ability to imitate human speech and perform tricks, this stocky, short-tailed African parrot is gray overall aside from its bright red tail and black wingtips. It lives in flocks in tropical lowland forests and mangroves, as well as farmland, feeding on seeds, nuts, and oil palm fruit. In some parts of its range, it spends the night in roosts of up to 10,000 birds.

Red-and-green macaw

Ara chloropterus

- ↔ 35 in (90 cm)
- 📍 N. and C. South America
- ⊗ Common

This big, long-tailed parrot is similar to the scarlet macaw but has green wing patches contrasting with its mainly red and blue plumage. It lives in tropical forests, where it forages in the tree canopy for fruit and seeds, usually in pairs that stay together for life. The mated pairs generally nest in tree holes, but in some regions, they use crevices in rock faces.

Other species

- Kakapo
Strigops habroptila » p356
- Kea
Nestor notabilis » p356
- Scarlet macaw
Ara macao » p97
- Sulfur-crested cockatoo
Cacatua galerita » p341

Cuckoos and turacos

Order Cuculiformes

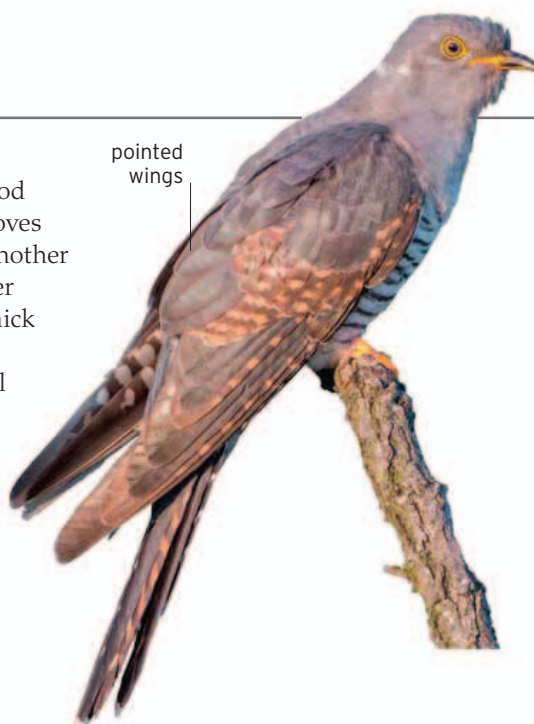
Common cuckoo

Cuculus canorus

- ↔ 32–33 cm (12½–13 in)
- 📍 Europe, Asia, NW. and Southern Africa
- ⊗ Common

A medium-sized, dark gray bird, the common cuckoo is more often heard than seen. The hollow, breathy, two-note “cuck-coo” call of the male is a welcome sign of spring in its Eurasian breeding range. But it is less welcome to many small birds, for the common

cuckoo is a notorious brood parasite. The female removes an egg from the nest of another species and lays one of her own; when the cuckoo chick hatches, it throws out the other eggs so it can eat all the food brought to the nest by its foster parents. Adult cuckoos resemble small-headed hawks in flight; the male has gray plumage and a dark-barred breast, while the female is browner.



Hoatzin

Opisthocomus hoazin

- ↔ 24–28 in (62–70 cm)
- 📍 N. South America
- ⊗ Common

This heavy-bodied tropical forest bird feeds almost entirely on leaves, digesting them with the help of bacteria in its gut. It nests on branches overhanging water; if threatened, the young dive into the water, then climb up through the vegetation using tiny wing claws.

Other species

- Greater roadrunner
Geococcyx californianus » p63